



**MSCF DATA SCIENCE CERTIFICATE
STUDENT HANDBOOK
2020 – 2021**

MSCF DATA SCIENCE CERTIFICATE STUDENT HANDBOOK

This handbook provides a statement of academic policies and information useful to students of the MSCF Data Science Certificate program at Carnegie Mellon. A link to the web version of this document is available at <https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194/pages/MSCF%20Handbooks?titleize=0>. No parts of this handbook may be reproduced or distributed without written permission from Richard Bryant, Executive Director, Computational Finance Program.

Certain sections of this document have been reproduced from the Carnegie Mellon Student Handbook, The Word. All questions regarding this publication or the University's policies should be directed to the MSCF Academic Advisors. Students are responsible for knowledge of these policies.

UNIVERSITY POLICIES & EXPECTATIONS

It is the responsibility of each member of the Carnegie Mellon community to be familiar with university policies and guidelines. In addition to this departmental graduate student handbook, the following resources are available to assist you in understanding community expectations:

- The Word/Student Handbook: www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/theword//index.html
- Academic Integrity Website: <https://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/academic-integrity.html>
- University Policies Website: www.cmu.edu/policies/
- Graduate Education Website: <http://www.cmu.edu/graduate/policies/index.html>

Please see Appendix A for additional information about The Word and University resources.

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY STATEMENT OF ASSURANCE

Carnegie Mellon University does not discriminate in admission, employment or administration of its programs or activities on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex, handicap or disability, age, sexual orientation, gender identity, religion, creed, ancestry, belief, veteran status or genetic information. Furthermore, Carnegie Mellon University does not discriminate and is required not to discriminate in violation of federal, state or local laws or executive orders.

Inquiries concerning the application of and compliance with this statement should be directed to the university ombudsman, Carnegie Mellon University, 5000 Forbes Avenue, Pittsburgh, PA 15213, telephone 412-268-1018. Obtain general information about Carnegie Mellon University by calling 412-268-2000.

THE CARNEGIE MELLON CODE

Students at Carnegie Mellon, because they are members of an academic community dedicated to the achievement of excellence, are expected to meet the highest standards of personal, ethical and moral conduct possible.

These standards require personal integrity, a commitment to honesty without compromise, as well as truth without equivocation and a willingness to place the good of the community above the good of the self. Obligations once undertaken must be met, commitments kept.

As members of the Carnegie Mellon community, individuals are expected to uphold the standards of the community in addition to holding others accountable for said standards. It is rare that the life of a student in an academic community can be so private that it will not affect the community as a whole or that the above standards do not apply.

The discovery, advancement and communication of knowledge are not possible without a commitment to these standards. Creativity cannot exist without acknowledgment of the creativity of others. New knowledge cannot be developed without credit for prior knowledge. Without the ability to trust that these principles will be observed, an academic community cannot exist.

The commitment of its faculty, staff and students to these standards contributes to the high respect in which the Carnegie Mellon degree is held. Students must not destroy that respect by their failure to meet these standards. Students who cannot meet them should voluntarily withdraw from the university.

The Carnegie Mellon Code can also be found on-line at:

<https://www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/theword/>

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MSCF DATA SCIENCE CERTIFICATE PROGRAM

Governance

The MSCF Data Science Certificate program is the joint venture among the Dietrich College of Humanities and Social Sciences, the Heinz College, the Mellon College of Science, and the Tepper School of Business. The Tepper School of Business administers the program. The program is governed by the MSCF Steering Committee (MSCFSC) with ultimate oversight provided by the four Deans of the four colleges participating in the joint venture and the Provost of the University. The MSCFSC is composed of five individuals - an academic head from each of the participating colleges (who is responsible for the academic resources of that school in the program) and the MSCF Executive Director.

Academic Advising and Resources

The Academic Advisors for MSCF Data Science Certificate students are the Director, MSCF Pittsburgh, and the Director, MSCF New York. Students are also welcome to reach out to faculty for additional support. Most courses have Teaching Assistant (TA) sessions or review sessions as well as office hours with a TA or faculty member. A student experiencing difficulty in a specific class should consult with his/her Academic Advisor, as well as the faculty member and/or the course's TA to find out which class resources are available.

CONTACT INFORMATION

MSCF Staff contact information can be found at:

<https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194/pages/contacts-mscf-staff>

MSCF Faculty contact information can be found at:

<https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194/pages/contacts-mscf-faculty>

ACADEMIC CALENDAR

This MSCF Data Science Certificate academic calendar is a modified version of the official Carnegie Mellon academic calendar and contains MSCF-specific dates and information. Please note that the MSCF Academic Calendar is for MSCF students and MSCF courses only. If MSCF students take non-MSCF courses, those courses are subject to the University academic calendar and/or the academic calendar for the specific college from which the course is taught.

Fall 2020 - Mini 1			
August	31	Monday	First Day of Mini 1 and Fall Semester Classes
September	7	Monday	Labor Day - No Classes
September	8	Tuesday	Add Deadline for Mini 1 Classes
September	14	Monday	Add Deadline for Fall Semester Classes
September	22	Tuesday	Drop Deadline for Mini 1 Classes
October	5	Monday	Withdrawal Deadline for Mini 1 Classes
October	12	Monday	Drop Deadline for Fall Semester Classes
October	16	Friday	No classes: Day for Community Engagement
October	19	Monday	Last Day of Mini 1 Classes
October	20 - 25	Tues - Sun	Mini 1 Reading Days and Final Exams
October	26 - 27	Mon - Tues	Fall Break - No Classes
October	28	Wednesday	Mini 1 Grades Due

Fall 2020 - Mini 2			
October	28	Wednesday	First Day of Mini 2 Classes
November	4	Wednesday	Add Deadline for Mini 2 Classes
November	9	Monday	Withdrawal Deadline for Fall Semester Classes
November	11	Wednesday	Drop Deadline for Mini 2 Classes
November	25 - 27	Wed - Fri	Thanksgiving Break - No Classes
November	25	Wednesday	Withdrawal Deadline for Mini 2 Classes
December	17	Thursday	Last Day of Mini 2 Classes
December	18 - 22	Fri - Tues	Mini 2 and Fall Semester Reading Days and Final Exams
December	23	Wednesday	Mini 2 and Fall Semester Grades Due

Spring 2021 - Mini 3			
January	8	Friday	Certification of December 2020 Graduates
January	11	Monday	First Day of Mini 3 and Spring Semester Classes
January	18	Monday	Martin Luther King Day - No Classes
January	19	Tuesday	Add Deadline for Mini 3 Classes
January	25	Monday	Add Deadline for Spring Semester Classes
February	1	Monday	Drop Deadline for Mini 3 Classes
February	15	Monday	Withdrawal Deadline for Mini 3 Classes
February	22	Monday	Drop Deadline for Spring Semester Classes
March	1	Monday	Last Day of Mini 3 Classes
March	2 - 7	Tues-Sun	Mini 3 Reading Days and Final Exams
March	8 - 12	Mon - Fri	Spring Break 2020 - No Classes
March	10	Wednesday	Mini 3 Grades due

Spring 2021 - Mini 4			
March	15	Monday	First Day of Mini 4 Classes
March	22	Monday	Add Deadline for Mini 4 Classes
March	29	Monday	Withdrawal Deadline for Spring Semester Classes
April	5	Monday	Drop Deadline for Mini 4 Classes
April	19	Monday	Withdrawal Deadline for Mini 4 Classes
April	30	Friday	Last Day of Mini 4 and Spring Semester Classes
May	1 - 7	Sat - Fri	Mini 4 and Spring Semester Reading Days and Final Exams
May	13	Thursday	Mini 4 and Spring Semester Grades due
May	15	Saturday	Tepper School Commencement Ceremony
May	16	Sunday	CMU Main Graduation Ceremony

Summer 2021			
May	10	Monday	First Day of Summer All Classes
May	31	Monday	Memorial Day - No Classes
May	25	Tuesday	Add Deadline for Summer All Classes
June	21	Monday	Drop Deadline for Summer All Classes
July	19	Monday	Withdrawal Deadline for Summer All Classes
August	2	Monday	First Day of MSCF Prep
August	13	Friday	Last Day of Summer All Classes
August	20	Friday	Grades Due for Summer All Classes
August	27	Friday	Last Day of MSCF Prep

Fall 2021 classes begin on Monday, August 30, 2021.

This MSCF Academic Calendar can be found online at:

<https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194/pages/mscf-academic-calendar-2020-2021>

SECTION 1: COURSE POLICIES AND REQUIREMENTS

1.1 MSCF Data Science Certificate Curriculum*

Mini 1	Fall 2020	
46921	Financial Data Science I	Required
Mini 2	Fall 2020	
46926	Machine Learning I	Required
46923	Financial Data Science II	Required
Mini 3	Spring 2021	
46927	Machine Learning II	Required
Mini 4	Spring 2021	
46929	Financial Time Series Analysis	Required

**Subject to change. See Section 1.12.*

1.2 MSCF Data Science Certificate Grades and Unit Requirements

Carnegie Mellon University and the MSCF program round to the hundredth for grade point average (GPA) and quality point average (QPA).

Grade* Quality Point Value

A+	4.33
A	4.00
A-	3.67
B+	3.33
B	3.00
B-	2.67
C+	2.33
C	2.00
C-	1.67
D+	1.33
D	1.00
R	0.00

Grades that do not affect Quality Point Average (QPA):

E	Exempt
I	Incomplete
O	Audit
W	Withdrawal
P	Pass
N	No Pass

MSCF Data Science Certificate candidates must complete the 30 units of MSCF Data Science Certificate courses required for graduation at the time of matriculation with a cumulative QPA in those courses of 3.00 or higher. All MSCF Data Science Certificate courses taken by a student will be included in the MSCF Data Science Certificate QPA calculation for graduation.

Students earn credit and grade points only if they have both registered for and completed a course.

1.3 Graduation Requirements

To graduate, students must:

1. Earn the total number of MSCF Data Science Certificate course credits required for graduation at the time of matriculation with a cumulative QPA in those courses of 3.00 or higher.
2. Have no delinquent accounts at the HUB.
3. Have returned all materials borrowed from Carnegie Mellon University.
4. Have no University Disciplinary Committee or University Academic Review Board reviews outstanding.
5. Be recommended for the MSCF Data Science Certificate as confirmed by the full-time faculty of the MSCF Steering Committee.

1.4 Summary of Graduate Student Appeal and Grievance Procedures

<https://www.cmu.edu/graduate/policies/appeal-grievance-procedures.html>.

Graduate students will find the Summary of Graduate Student Appeal and Grievance Procedures on the Graduate Education Resource webpage. This document summarizes processes available to graduate students who seek review of academic and non-academic issues. Generally, graduate students are expected to seek informal resolution of all concerns within the applicable department, unit or program before invoking formal processes. When an informal resolution cannot be reached, however, a graduate student who seeks further review of the matter is to follow the formal procedures outlined here. These appeal and grievance procedures shall apply to students in all graduate programs of the University. Students should refer to the department specific information in this handbook for department and college information about the administration and academic policies of the program. Additionally, students may confer with the Graduate Education Office, graded@andrew.cmu.edu for support on issues of process or other concerns as they navigate conflicts.

If a student wishes to dispute a grade on an assignment or an exam, he/she should discuss the grade directly with the faculty member teaching the course. If a student wishes to dispute a final grade, he/she should follow the process outlined in the Summary of Graduate Student Appeal and Grievance Procedures, *Appealing Final Grades*, which can be found at:

<http://www.cmu.edu/graduate/policies/appeal-grievance-procedures.html>.

Final grades will be changed only in exceptional circumstances and only with the approval of the instructor and the department, unit or program. Grading is a matter of sound discretion of the instructor and final grades are rarely changed without the consent of the instructor who assigned the grade. The following circumstances are the unusual exceptions that may warrant a grade appeal: (a) the final grade assigned for a course is based on manifest error (e.g. a clear error such as arithmetic error in computing a grade or failure to grade one of the answers on an exam), or (b) the faculty or staff member who assigned the grade did so in violation of a University policy.

1.5 Statute of Limitations

MSCF Data Science Certificate students must complete all requirements for the MSCF Data Science Certificate in two consecutive academic semesters. Exceptions

to this policy are possible only under a Leave of Absence, a suspension, or as approved by the student's Academic Advisor.

Once this time-to-degree limit has lapsed, the person may resume work towards a certificate only if newly admitted to a currently offered certificate program under criteria determined by that program.

Under extraordinary circumstances, such as leave of absence, military or public service, family or parental leave, or temporary disability, a school or college may, upon the relevant department's recommendation and with the written approval of the dean (or designate), defer the lapse for a period commensurate with the duration of that interruption.

1.6 Courses Taken Pass/Fail

All MSCF Data Science Certificate courses must be taken for a grade.

1.7 Incomplete Grades

Students must complete all course requirements on time; exceptions are determined solely by the professor, and a grade of "I" is assigned for incomplete courses. All incomplete courses must be completed; students are encouraged to resolve the incomplete grade as soon as possible. The faculty member has the discretion to establish a timeline for completion in the following term and not to exceed the end of the next semester. Any incomplete grade not resolved within one semester will become an "R" (a failing grade). An incomplete in a required course prevents the course from serving as a prerequisite for other courses. Students are responsible for monitoring the status of their grades and taking steps to remove incomplete grades from their academic records.

1.8 International Students

Carnegie Mellon University does not provide visa support services to non-U.S. citizens enrolling in the MSCF Data Science Certificate program.

1.9 New Policy Protocol

Changes to the MSCF Data Science Certificate curriculum or any MSCF policy can be made at any time. Students will be made aware of any changes in an email from the MSCF program. All curriculum changes will be communicated to the students in time for course registration.

SECTION 2: REGISTRATION AND ENROLLMENT

2.1 Course Registration

MSCF Data Science Certificate students are responsible for registering themselves for all of their courses, each semester of the MSCF Data Science Certificate program. When course registration opens, Student Services will email the students the list of courses for which they should register. Courses must be added and dropped by the add and drop deadlines for mini. Add/drop deadlines are shown on the MSCF Academic Calendar at <https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194>. Students are responsible for dropping elective courses they choose not to take. Student Services performs an audit following each add/drop deadline to confirm students are registered for the courses they will need for graduation.

2.2 Certification Process

The MSCF Academic Advisors audit the final grades for all graduating students for all of their MSCF Data Science Certificate courses. The MSCF Steering Committee reviews this audit and confirms that each student has successfully completed the program. The MSCF Academic Advisors then certify all graduates in the University system, after which certificates are ordered and mailed. Students who pass each of the five graded courses with a cumulative QPA of 3.00 or more will receive an “MSCF Certificate of Data Science” from the Master of Science in Computational Finance program.

All graduating students must check their student accounts to confirm that their diploma mailing addresses are up to date. Diplomas will not be mailed to students who have not entered a diploma mailing address in their account.

2.3 Add, Drop, Withdrawal Deadlines and Drop Vouchers

The MSCF academic calendar includes add, drop, and withdrawal deadlines each mini:

- The **add deadline** each mini is the date by which students must add courses to their course schedules.
- The **drop deadline** each mini is the date by which students must drop courses to their course schedules.
- The **withdrawal deadline** each mini is the date by which students must submit a withdrawal form in order to withdraw from the course after the drop period and receive a “W” on their transcript.
 - The course withdrawal form can be found at:
<https://www.cmu.edu/hub/docs/course-withdrawal.pdf>
 - Withdrawals made in this time frame appear permanently on the student’s transcript as a “W” and students who withdraw from the university or take a leave of absence before completing 60% of the semester will be assessed tuition based on the number of days completed within the semester. This includes calendar days, class and non-class days, from the first day of classes to the last day of final exams. Breaks which last five days or longer, including the preceding and subsequent weekends, are not counted. Thanksgiving and Spring Break are not counted. There is no tuition adjustment after 60% of the semester is completed. More information on this tuition adjustment policy can be found in section 7.4, or at <https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/tuition/adjustment/>
 - Students are unable to withdraw from a course after the withdrawal deadline. After the withdrawal deadline, whether or not the student sits for the final or submits a final project, a grade based on his or her performance in the class will be assigned and will appear permanently on the student’s transcript. Full tuition will be assessed for the course.
- **Late course drops and vouchers:** MSCF Data Science Certificate students are permitted one drop voucher per year of study and may use only one voucher per semester. Students may use drop vouchers up until the last day of classes each semester. Courses dropped using a voucher will be removed from the student’s record, as long as the drop is confirmed in SIO by the student within 24 hours of receiving the automated voucher email. For instructions on how to use a drop voucher, please visit: <https://www.cmu.edu/hub/registrar/course-changes/index.html>

2.4 Retaking Courses

Students may not retake for credit a course previously completed (withdrawing from a course does not equal completed).

2.5 Exam Procedures

MSCF proctors will verify each student's identity in person. All students enrolled in a course are expected to take exams simultaneously. The MSCF program has a uniform exam proctoring policy across all courses.

Exam proctors will enforce the following rules:

- Students must put everything not needed for the exam in their backpacks (including cell phones) and leave all backpacks at the front of the classroom.
- A proctor must be present in the examination room at all times.
- Proctors who read or work on their computers during the exam will survey the room every minute or two and walk through the room at least once every five minutes.
- Whenever possible, enough rooms should be scheduled for the exam so that no student sits adjacent to another student.
- Only one student is permitted to be outside the classroom at a time. Students who leave the classroom to call the professor with a question must be monitored.
- For exams during which students are allowed to use their laptops:
 - Screen protectors are not permitted.
 - Computers must be in English.
 - A lockdown browser may be used.
- Students who fail to comply with these rules are subject to disciplinary action at the discretion of the professor.

A make-up exam will be given only in documented emergencies (e.g., a medical problem, accident, family emergency) and only after obtaining permission from the professor. A doctor's excuse is required for a student to miss an exam for illness or other medical problem. Work responsibilities, job interviews, recruiting/leisure travel and other personal plans are not sufficient cause to justify a make-up exam. Make-up exams may not be taken before the regularly scheduled exam unless the professor writes a different exam.

2.6 Second-Chance Exams

At the instructor's discretion, students who perform poorly in an MSCF Data Science Certificate course, including on the final exam, may be given a second chance final exam. If the instructor chooses to exercise this option, the following policy applies.

1. The opportunity to take the second chance exam must be extended to all students whose course grade would otherwise be below some threshold.
2. Students whose grades improve as a result of the second chance exam cannot receive a course grade higher than that received by students not eligible to take the second chance exam.
3. In order for a student taking the second chance exam to attain the course grade just above the threshold for second chance exam eligibility, mastery of the material comparable to or better than that achieved by

students on the original final exam whose course grade is at that level must be demonstrated on the second chance exam.

4. The second chance exam will be written and proctored.
5. If the second chance exam is to be given when classes are not in session, the date of the exam must be specified in the course syllabus.

Second chance exams are different from make-up exams. Make-up exams are given to students who miss a scheduled exam for a valid reason.

SECTION 3: ACADEMIC POLICIES

3.1 MSCF Steering Committee Review Process

The MSCF Steering Committee (MSCFSC) is authorized to review an MSCF Data Science Certificate student for any Academic Integrity violation.

Additionally, if a student fails a required course and/or cannot continue in the normal MSCF Data Science Certificate curriculum for any reason, the student will be reviewed by the MSCF Steering Committee.

An MSCFSC review for Academic Integrity violations can result in the MSCFSC recommending an additional penalty beyond the course-level penalty.

If a student is to be reviewed by the MSCFSC, the student's Academic Advisor will notify the student, give the student a guide outlining the review process, and invite the student to prepare a letter to the MSCFSC. The MSCFSC will consider the facts and circumstances, the letter, and additional information provided by the student's Academic Advisor, and come to a decision.

The MSCF Executive Director and/or the student's Academic Advisor will notify the student of the MSCFSC's decision, at which time the student will be given a letter from the MSCF Executive Director detailing the MSCFSC's decision and the appeal process.

Students will be advised that they can discuss their MSCFSC review with the Assistant Vice Provost for Graduate Education.

3.2 Academic Integrity Policy

Please review the University Policy on Academic Integrity at: <https://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/academic-integrity.html>. The policy includes the University expectations around academic integrity and provides definitions of cheating, plagiarism, and unauthorized assistance.

A review of the University's Academic Disciplinary Actions procedures (<https://www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/theword/academic-discipline/index.html>) is also recommended. These procedures outline the process for investigating, reporting, and adjudicating violations of the University Policy on Academic Integrity. The procedures also outline the appeal process.

It is the expectation of the MSCF Data Science Certificate program that students have read the University's policy on Academic Integrity and understand all elements related to cheating, plagiarism and unauthorized assistance, and that if they have any questions they will ask their course faculty, MSCF Academic Advisor, or the MSCF Executive Director.

Academic Integrity violations will also result in academic review by the MSCFSC (see Section 3.1). The MSCFSC can recommend that an additional penalty be imposed, in addition to the course-level penalty. Potential penalties for Academic Integrity violations imposed by faculty range from a lower grade on an assignment to failure of the course. MSCF Steering Committee penalty recommendations can include suspension or dismissal from the MSCF program.

3.3 University Suspension

University Suspension is a forced, temporary leave from the university. There are two types of suspension for students:

Disciplinary Suspension is the result of serious personal misconduct and is imposed by the Office of Student Affairs. See The Word/Student Handbook at <https://www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/theword/>

Administrative Suspension is the result of failure to meet university financial obligations or failure to comply with federal, state or local health regulations and is imposed by Enrollment Services. See the Student Accounts Receivable Collection Policy and Procedures for financial obligation at <https://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/suspension-required-withdrawal-policy.html> or contact Student Health Services for information about health regulations at <https://www.cmu.edu/health-services/index.html>

The Carnegie Mellon University Suspension Policy is available at: <http://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/suspension-required-withdrawal-policy.html>

3.4 Withdrawal of a Degree

The university reserves the right to withdraw a degree even though it has been granted should there be discovery that the work upon which it was based or the academic records in support of it had been falsified. In such a case, the degree will be withdrawn promptly upon discovery of the falsification. The complete reference to this university policy is available at: <https://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/withdrawal-of-a-degree.html>.

SECTION 4: CODE OF CONDUCT

4.1 The Carnegie Mellon Code

Students at Carnegie Mellon, because they are members of an academic community dedicated to the achievement of excellence, are expected to meet the highest standards of personal, ethical and moral conduct possible.

These standards require personal integrity, a commitment to honesty without compromise, as well as truth without equivocation and a willingness to place the good of the community above the good of the self. Obligations once undertaken must be met, commitments kept.

As members of the Carnegie Mellon community, individuals are expected to uphold the standards of the community in addition to holding others accountable for said standards. It is rare that the life of a student in an academic community can be so private that it will not affect the community as a whole or that the above standards do not apply.

The discovery, advancement and communication of knowledge are not possible

without a commitment to these standards. Creativity cannot exist without acknowledgment of the creativity of others. New knowledge cannot be developed without credit for prior knowledge. Without the ability to trust that these principles will be observed, an academic community cannot exist.

The commitment of its faculty, staff and students to these standards contributes to the high respect in which the Carnegie Mellon degree is held. Students must not destroy that respect by their failure to meet these standards. Students who cannot meet them should voluntarily withdraw from the university.

The Carnegie Mellon Code can also be found on-line at:

<https://www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/theword/code/index.html>

4.2 MSCF Ethics

MSCF students are required to take and pass an online Academic Integrity module before their first and last semesters in the MSCF Data Science Certificate Program. MSCF Data Science Certificate students are also required to attend an Ethics session with the MSCF Steering Committee during orientation, and a handbook session during orientation, during which students are made aware of all of the MSCF rules regarding academic integrity and all other MSCF policies and procedures. MSCF Data Science Certificate students are also required to complete an online quiz which confirms they have read the Carnegie Mellon Code and agree to adhere to the code. Details on the ethical components of the MSCF program can be found at:

<https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194/pages/ethics>

4.3 Conduct of Classes

1. Students are expected to adhere to the Carnegie Mellon Code. Faculty are expected to remind students at the beginning of the course and immediately prior to any exam of the student's agreement with and adherence to the Carnegie Mellon Code, as set forth in the MSCF Student Handbook.
2. If students choose to attend a lecture in person, they are expected to arrive at class on time. Tardiness is disruptive to the entire class and is disrespectful of classmates and the faculty member. Consequences of tardiness are at the discretion of the professor. Professors may deny tardy students admission to the classroom.
3. Students are expected to complete the readings, case preparations and other assignments prior to each class session and, if attending an in-person or synchronous online lecture, be prepared to actively participate in class discussion. Consequences of late work are at the discretion of the professor.
5. Laptops and smartphones in the classroom should be used only as directed by the professor. Answering phones while class is in session is not permitted.
6. For team projects, faculty may allow students to form their own teams or may assign teams at his/her discretion.
7. Students who miss work because of religious beliefs may make arrangements with the professor, provided the missed work is completed as designated.
8. Non-MSCF students often seek to take MSCF classes. The MSCF program

recognizes that CMU students should receive as many benefits as the University can provide. However, our primary responsibility is to our MSCF students. In an effort to balance these two objectives, the MSCF program permits a limited number of non-MSCF students to enroll or audit MSCF courses (dependent upon faculty permission and MSCF class size) and a limit on the number of MSCF courses they may take.

4.4 Computing Policy

<https://www.cmu.edu/policies/information-technology/computing.html>

The Carnegie Mellon University Computing Policy establishes standards for the responsible use of the campus network and computing facilities. These standards of acceptable behavior also extend beyond the campus community into the Internet. This policy applies to all users of Carnegie Mellon computing systems, including students, faculty and staff, and any others granted the use of university computing resources. It applies to the use of all computing facilities owned, leased, operated or contracted by Carnegie Mellon. As used in this policy, terms such as “computing,” “computing/communications systems,” “computing resources,” etc., refer to all computers, communication systems, and peripherals, software, telephones and systems with similar functions, which are owned by Carnegie Mellon, or which utilize Carnegie Mellon infrastructure such as telephone lines or computer networks. The full policy including enforcement provisions is: <http://www.cmu.edu/policies/information-technology/computing.html>.

Inappropriate behavior in the use of computers is punishable under the general University policies and regulations regarding faculty, students and staff. The offenses mentioned in this policy range from relatively minor to extremely serious, though even a minor offense may be treated severely if it is repeated or malicious. Certain offenses may also be subject to prosecution under federal state or local laws. Questions concerning this policy or its intent should be directed to the Information Security Office at iso@andrew.cmu.edu.

4.5 Community Standards

All students at Carnegie Mellon University must abide by the University’s policy on Community Standards: <https://www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/theword/community-standards/index.html>

Students are expected to have read the University’s policy on Community Standards and to bring any questions to their MSCF Academic Advisor.

4.6 Alcohol

The drinking age in Pennsylvania and New York is 21 years of age. Anyone under the age of 21 is prohibited from purchasing, possessing, or consuming alcohol. In all circumstances, the University expects students to conduct themselves responsibly, both individually and collectively. Abusive or excessive consumption of alcohol that interferes with the rights of other persons, inflicts personal injury, or causes damage to property will result in severe disciplinary action, including suspension or expulsion. While Carnegie Mellon accepts no responsibility for the direct supervision of social activities organized by its students and student organizations, the University reserves the right to review plans for social events that use University facilities and to set special requirements to ensure that all responsibilities are met. Consumption of alcoholic beverages in classrooms is forbidden. Following are the rules for social events in the MSCF program as set forth in Carnegie Mellon University’s Community Policies at:

<https://www.cmu.edu/policies/administrative-and-governance/alcohol-and-drug-policy.html>

1. Social events may not start until all classes for that day, including evening classes, are over (unless special arrangements are made with the MSCF Executive Director), nor may they start before completion of all exams in the building on that day. The MSCF program does not permit events with alcohol on the day prior to the final exam period in any mini.
2. All social events providing alcoholic beverages must also provide food and non-alcoholic beverages.
3. Alcoholic beverages are not to be consumed in any public area either owned or controlled by the University (i.e. hallways, lounges, and foyers).
4. Permission to serve alcoholic beverages at events attended by students may only be obtained from the Carnegie Mellon Dean of Student Affairs Office. Assistance in processing alcohol requests can be obtained through the Tepper Student Services office. A trained staff member or faculty member must take personal responsibility for ensuring that alcoholic beverages are served only to students of legal age before permission will be given.
5. After the event, the designated area must be left as neat as possible. Any damages must be reported to the MSCF Academic Advisors and to Carnegie Mellon Security.

4.7 Policy Against Sexual Harassment and Sexual Assault

The University prohibits sex-based discrimination, sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating/ domestic violence and stalking. The University also prohibits retaliation against individuals who bring forward such concerns or allegations in good faith. The policy can be viewed in its entirety at: http://www.cmu.edu/policies/documents/SA_SH.htm. If you have been impacted by any of these issues, you are encouraged to make contact with any of the following resources:

- Office of Title IX Initiatives, <http://www.cmu.edu/title-ix/>, 412-268-7125, tix@cmu.edu
- University Police, 412-268-2323
- University Health Services, 412-268-2157
- Counseling & Psychological Services, 412-268-2922

Additional resources and information can be found at:

<https://www.cmu.edu/title-ix/resources-and-information/resources.html>.

4.8 Intellectual Property

The MSCF Data Science Certificate program adheres to the Intellectual Property Policy guidelines as set forth in Carnegie Mellon University's Academic Policies at <http://www.cmu.edu/policies/documents/IntellProp.html>.

4.9 Confidentiality of Hearing Procedures

The Federal Educational Rights and Privacy Act of 1974 (FERPA) established requirements for educational institutions with regard to the privacy of students' educational records, which include academic grades and discipline records.

Members of any review board may become aware of some information in students' educational records because they read incident reports prior to the hearing in which they are involved, hear testimony during hearings and are aware of the possible hearing outcomes. Consequently, board members have a responsibility to protect student's privacy at all times by not revealing hearing information outside the hearing process or the guidelines of FERPA.

4.10 Ombudsperson

Students may confer with the university graduate ombudsman from the Graduate Education Office, graded@andrew.cmu.edu for support on issues of process or other concerns as they navigate conflicts.

Additionally, the MSCF Academic Advisors are available to all students to assist with difficult academic or personal situations where a confidential sounding board and/or an intermediary can be helpful. Examples of situations where students are encouraged to seek advice or assistance include:

- Conflict with other group members that is difficult to resolve within the group
- Issues related to diversity and inclusion or the department climate
- Personal concerns that interfere significantly with the ability to meet program requirements. These might be due to health, family or financial challenges.

Upon the student's request, information shared will be kept in confidence, however, note that issues related to sexual harassment or sexual assault (see section 4.9) are required to be directed to Title IX coordinators.

In the event that a difficulty cannot be resolved within the department, the student's academic advisor can also assist with following the grievance procedures for resolving difficult matters, which are available here: www.cmu.edu/graduate/policies/appeal-grievance-procedures.html.

4.11 Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)

Carnegie Mellon and the Tepper School of Business will not disclose personally identifiable information from your education records without your consent except for directory information and other exceptions specified by the law. Under FERPA, directory information is personally identifiable information that may be disclosed without your consent, unless you specifically request the university not to do so. It is used for purposes like compiling campus directories. If you do not want your directory information to be disclosed, you must notify The HUB in writing within the first 15 days of the semester. Under FERPA, Carnegie Mellon and the Tepper School of Business may release personally identifiable information from your education records without your prior consent to school officials with legitimate education interests. School officials have a "legitimate education interest" if they need to review education records in order to fulfill their professional responsibilities. This policy is available in full online: <http://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/privacy-rights-students.html>

SECTION 5: LEAVE OF ABSENCE AND WITHDRAWAL

5.1 Leave of Absence

Students may petition for a one-time Leave of Absence (LOA) effective up to two calendar years from the date of the LOA. To initiate the leave, a student must

meet with his/her Academic Advisor to complete the necessary paperwork, including the MSCF LOA checklist, and the official University LOA form, which can be found on The HUB website at: <https://www.cmu.edu/hub/docs/loa.pdf>

Students attending the program on a visa should consult the Office of International Education before processing a LOA. A student who wishes to return from LOA must notify his/her Academic Advisor of his/her plan to return at the beginning of the mini prior to the mini they wish to return. For example, a student planning to return for Spring 21, Mini 3 must notify the program of his/her plans to return by the beginning of Fall 20, Mini 2. Students are not permitted to attend classes or maintain employment as students at Carnegie Mellon while their leave is in effect. Student's campus ID and email accounts are suspended during a Leave of Absence. A student electing an LOA will forgo any outstanding MSCF scholarship payable had the student completed the program pursuant to the terms of award extended at the time of admission.

5.2 Withdrawal

Withdrawal from the MSCF program means, "to leave with no intent to return." A withdrawal is initiated by the student through a meeting with an MSCF Academic Advisor and by completing a Withdrawal form, located on The HUB website at: <https://www.cmu.edu/hub/docs/withdrawal.pdf>

Students attending the program on a visa should consult the Office of International Education before processing a withdrawal. A student who withdraws from the program is not permitted to attend classes and will have his/her campus ID and email account terminated. Students will be contacted via telephone, email, and certified letter. If there is no response within two months, the student is presumed withdrawn. Emergency situations will be considered on a case-by-case basis. If a student withdraws from the MSCF program, he/she must reapply and be admitted to the program in order to return.

SECTION 6: ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

6.1 Course Descriptions and Prerequisites

Course descriptions and course prerequisites are available online at <https://www.cmu.edu/mscf/academics/curriculum/index.html>. Students must fulfill all prerequisite course requirements to register for MSCF Data Science Certificate courses. Only the course professor may make exceptions to these prerequisites.

6.2 Course Materials

In most instances, course packets are distributed at no cost to students. Required textbooks, some course packets, and other course-related materials must be purchased. Students are expected to consult the course material and be prepared for the first day of class. Only those students whose names appear on the course roster will receive course materials.

6.3 Courses Content in Canvas

Students have access to course content in Canvas when they are registered for the course. Students will lose access to the course content when the course is completed. Students should download all of the course data that they wish to keep before the course ends.

6.4 Recording of Lectures

The MSCF program records and makes available through the internet most course lectures delivered in the program. The primary purpose of these recordings is to serve as a resource for reviewing material after class. A secondary purpose is to provide access to the material for students unable to attend due to unavoidable conflicts. While we make every effort to capture and upload these videos in a timely manner, we cannot guarantee each lecture will be captured. Unless advised otherwise by the faculty member teaching the course, these recordings will remain available through graduation for the class cohort for which they were recorded.

6.5 Library Resources

Library resources specific to the educational and career interests of MSCF students are available online: <http://guides.library.cmu.edu/mscfny>

6.6 Academic Calendar

The MSCF Academic Calendar differs from the Official Carnegie Mellon Calendar and includes additional MSCF-specific dates. Students are advised to study this calendar carefully and plan accordingly. The calendar can be found at <https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194>.

6.7 Course and Faculty Schedules

The MSCF course and faculty schedule can be found on the MSCF website at <https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194>. The schedule lists the number, title, professor, section, days, hours and room for each course.

6.8 Examination Schedules

Final examinations generally occur at the end of each mini-semester. Exams may be given on evenings and weekends. Exam schedules are shown on the MSCF website at <https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194>. Students are responsible for knowing their examination schedules. The date range for exam periods is also listed on the Academic Calendar. If a student need to know when exams are, and the final exam schedule is not yet posted, students can find the general exam dates on the Academic Calendar, which can be found at: <https://canvas.cmu.edu/courses/3194>.

6.9 Course and Professor Evaluations

Student participation in course and faculty evaluations is both expected and essential; the MSCF Steering Committee relies heavily upon the input provided through these surveys. During the final weeks of class, students will be requested to provide honest and comprehensive information on both the course and the professor for each course in which the student is registered. All MSCF course evaluations are anonymous. Although evaluations are online and may be completed at any time during the evaluation period, a time is also set aside in each class for students to complete their evaluations.

6.10 Transcripts, Verifications and Unofficial Grade Reports

Enrollment services is the only University office authorized to issue official transcripts and verifications. There are two types of verifications: enrollment verifications and degree verifications. An enrollment verification officially provides proof of enrollment at the university. Enrollment information can only

be verified from the student record and what is reflected on the student record. A degree verification officially provides proof of degree(s) awarded, and/or graduation date, and/or or expected degree(s), and/or expected graduation date. More information about ordering official transcripts, verifications, and certified electric diplomas is available at: <https://www.cmu.edu/hub/registrar/student-records/index.html>.

University policy prohibits the release of grades over the telephone, by fax or email. You may access your grades in the Academic Info section on Student Information Online (SIO) at <http://www.cmu.edu/hub/sio>.

6.11 Class Rankings

Only the MSCF Steering Committee has access to class ranking information. Class rankings are not released to anyone, including students.

SECTION 7: TUITION AND FINANCIAL AID

7.1 Tuition Requirement

Students receive degrees only after meeting all university financial obligations.

7.2 Tuition Payments/Billing/Enrollment

The Student Accounts Office creates electronic invoices each month. Once invoices are created, a notification is sent to the student's Andrew e-mail account alerting the student that an invoice is ready to view on Student Information Online (SIO) www.cmu.edu/hub/sio. Enrollment is not complete until a student pays the amount due by the due date indicated on the invoice. Past due accounts are subject to a 1.5% interest charge each month until the balance is paid in full. Students with loans or pending financial aid must complete registration before the funds are credited to their account.

Students may view invoices and check recent student account activity under the "Finances" section of SIO.

7.3 Students with Delinquent Accounts

Student accounts are administered by the Student Accounts Office. In-depth information may be found on their website, <https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/billing/>

Students are responsible for paying their student account charges by the 15th of each month. Please reference the current Student Financial Obligation terms at <https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/billing/>

7.4 Tuition Refund

Tuition is refunded 100% until the course drop deadline. After the drop deadline, students who withdraw from the university or take a leave of absence before completing 60% of the semester will be assessed tuition based on the number of days completed within the semester. This includes calendar days, class and non-class days, from the first day of classes to the last day of final exams. Breaks which last five days or longer, including the preceding and subsequent weekends, are not counted. Thanksgiving and Spring Break are not counted. There is no tuition adjustment after 60% of the semester is completed.

The complete Carnegie Mellon University tuition adjustment policy can be found at: <https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/tuition/adjustment/>

7.5 Financial Aid Support

MSCF students should consult the graduate student financial aid information found on The HUB website: <https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/financial-aid/graduate/>. Students will find information about funding options and how to apply for financial aid and other helpful links.

All students, regardless of whether they are financial aid recipients, are required to confirm agreement to the university's student financial aid terms and conditions upon their initial log-in to SIO and before any financial aid disbursement to their account. Learn more at www.cmu.edu/sfs/financial-aid/terms.html.

Graduate students who find themselves in need of immediate funds for emergency situations should contact the Office of the Dean of Student Affairs (see Appendix A), www.cmu.edu/student-affairs, to inquire about an Emergency Student Loan.

7.6 Loans

Eligible students may apply for education loans to pay tuition and allowable education-related costs. An international student generally must have a credit-worthy cosigner to enter into an education loan. See <https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/financial-aid/> to learn more about loan options. All federal loans and most non-federal loans require students to be enrolled for at least 18 units per semester and meet all other qualifying factors.

7.7 Satisfactory Academic Progress for Federal Financial Aid (SAP)

Federal financial aid recipients are required to maintain satisfactory academic progress in their course of study for continued eligibility. Students are required to complete 80% of their attempted courses each semester, maintain the minimum cumulative QPA as required by their program of study and complete their program of study within a maximum period of 1.5 times the standard program length in order to maintain financial aid eligibility. The complete SAP policy may be found on our website, <https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/financial-aid/policies/>.

7.8 Federal Financial Aid Adjustments for Withdrawing Students

Irrespective of tuition charges, when a student withdraws from all classes, federal financial aid is adjusted in the following order on a pro-rated basis as per federal regulations until 60% of the period used to calculate the federal reward is completed: Federal Direct Unsubsidized Loan, and/or Federal Direct Grad Plus Loan.

Federal aid recipients who are withdrawing are strongly encouraged to contact their HUB Liaison to learn what portion of disbursed financial aid is unearned and must be canceled or returned to the lender. Information about the university's student leave policy may be found at: <https://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/student-leave.html>

7.9 Important Financial Aid Dates

You may find information on the Student Financial Services website about financial aid and tuition due dates, expected refunds dates, and other important

dates that may help you with your financial planning. See

<https://www.cmu.edu/sfs/>

SECTION 8: MISCELLANEOUS

8.1 Emergency Protocols

In the event of an emergency, www.cmu.edu will be promptly updated with information and a link to www.cmu.edu/alert where more in-depth information will be available. All students, faculty and staff in the Carnegie Mellon community are also encouraged to register for the CMU-Alert service, which sends voice and/or text messages to registered phones in the event of a campus emergency. Students, faculty and staff may register for the service online at www.cmu.edu/alert.

The privacy of contact information is guaranteed. Registrants will be contacted by the CMU-Alert system only if there is a campus emergency or during tests of the system in the spring and fall semesters. Text and voice options may carry a nominal fee for recipients depending on cell phone carriers and cell phone plans. The recipient is responsible for these fees. Questions regarding the CMU-Alert service should be sent via email to cmu-alert@andrew.cmu.edu.

For less threatening, but more common weather-related or service (power outage, water service issues) the Tepper School will alert students via email, Web notices and classroom announcements. Snow delays and cancellations will also be noted at www.cmu.edu and can often be found on major television news channels.

8.2 Student ID Cards

The official photo Carnegie Mellon Identification Card (ID) is an important document, granting the student access to CMU buildings and the campus in New York (55 Broad Street, 5th floor).

MSCF Data Science Certificate students will be contacted by their Academic Advisor with details on how to obtain an ID card.

The Carnegie Mellon Student ID card photo can be submitted through the online ID Photo Submission Application at <http://www.cmu.edu/idplus/idcards/idphotos.html>.

ID cards can be replaced for a fee, after the student completes an "Identification Card Request" form, which can be found on The HUB website at: <http://www.cmu.edu/idplus/docs/id-request.pdf>. The form should be submitted to ID Card Services in The Hub.

In addition, Carnegie Mellon students showing their photo ID card receive free access to many Pittsburgh attractions through the Arts Pass Program. More information about the Arts Pass Program can be found at: <https://www.cmu.edu/idplus/services/artspass.html>

8.3 Updating Student Information

Students are required to update their contact information in a timely manner by logging into the My Info section of Student Information Online (SIO) at <http://www.cmu.edu/hub/sio>. Students are responsible for any failure to receive official University notices as a result of incorrect addresses on file.

8.4 MSCF Town Meeting

Once each semester, all MSCF students are invited to participate in a “Town Meeting” with the MSCF Steering Committee at which time any MSCF-related concern may be expressed. Each meeting will include both the New York and Pittsburgh campuses and will have MSCF Steering Committee members present at each location. Student participation in these meetings is strongly encouraged.

8.5 MSCF Marketing and Public Relations Guidelines

To assure consistency in all MSCF communications and to maximize external visibility to target audiences, the marketing and communications staff works together to coordinate key messages and activities involving publicity. Caitlin Kizielewicz (ckiz@andrew.cmu.edu) is the point-of-contact between news media and MSCF faculty, students and staff. If contacted by a media representative, please contact Ms. Kizielewicz immediately who can assist you with strategic planning for publicity, interview preparation, and/or developing content for the MSCF website and social media channels.

8.6 Security & Fire Safety Report Notice

Carnegie Mellon University publishes an annual campus security and fire safety report describing the university’s security, alcohol and drug, sexual assault, and fire safety policies and containing statistics about the number and type of crimes committed on the campus and the number and cause of fires in campus residence facilities during the preceding three years. You can obtain a copy by contacting the Carnegie Mellon Police Department at 412-268-6232. The annual security and fire safety report is also available online at www.cmu.edu/police/annualreports.

8.7 Change of Address

Departments are asked to encourage students to keep their current local address up-to-date in SIO. This supports a university initiative to have accurate living information for students for official program/department/college/university notices, the ability to facilitate wellness checks, ensure international students are in compliance with visa requirements, etc.

8.8 Maternity Accommodation Protocol

<https://www.cmu.edu/graduate/programs-services/maternity-accommodation-protocol.html>

Students whose anticipated delivery date is during the course of the semester may consider taking time away from their coursework and/or research responsibilities. All female students who give birth to a child while engaged in coursework or research are eligible to take either a short-term absence or formal leave of absence. Students in course work should consider either working with their course instructor to receive incomplete grades, or elect to drop to part-time status or to take a semester leave of absence. Students engaged in research must work with their faculty to develop plans for the research for the time they are away.

Students are encouraged to consult with relevant university faculty and staff as soon as possible as they begin making plans regarding time away. Students must contact the Office of the Dean of Student Affairs to register for Maternity Accommodations. Students will complete an information form and meet with a member of the Dean’s Office staff to determine resources and procedures

appropriate for the individual student. Planning for the student's discussion with her academic contact(s) (advisor, associate dean, etc.) will be reviewed during this meeting.

8.9 Employment Eligibility Verification

If you are receiving a stipend, you are going to be a TA or you are planning to have a position with CMU then Employment Eligibility Verification is required. Form I-9 must be completed within 3 business days of beginning work for any type of compensation (stipend or employment). Additional details are highlighted below.

To ensure compliance with federal law, Carnegie Mellon University maintains the [Employment Eligibility Verification \(I-9\) Policy \[pdf\]](#) covering the university's I-9 and E-Verify requirements:

Every individual receiving a stipend from CMU or employed by CMU must comply with the I-9 Policy by completing the Form I-9 within three business days following the first day of stipend start date/employment.

Individuals who expect to work on a federally funded project are further responsible for submitting an E-Verify Processing Request Form to the Office of Human Resources.

For more information, please see CMU's [Guidance for Completing the Form I-9 and E-Verify Requirements at CMU \[pdf\]](#), or visit the Human Resources Service website to [learn more about Form I-9 and E-Verify](#) and to [schedule an appointment to complete the Form I-9](#).

8.10 Consensual Intimate Relationship Policy Regarding Undergraduate Students

<https://www.cmu.edu/policies/student-and-student-life/consensual-relationships.html>

This policy addresses the circumstances in which romantic, sexual or amorous relationships/interactions with undergraduate students, even if consensual, are inappropriate and prohibited. The purpose of this policy is to assure healthy professional relationships. This policy is not intended to discourage consensual intimate relationships unless there is a conflicting professional relationship in which one party has authority over the other as in the policy.

Appendix A: Highlighted University Resources for Graduate Students and The WORD, Student Handbook

Key Offices for Graduate Student Support

Graduate Education Office

www.cmu.edu/graduate; grad-ed@cmu.edu

The Graduate Education Office provides central support for all Master's and Doctoral students with a focus on their academic experience at Carnegie Mellon. The Graduate Education Office serves as a hub for connecting graduate students to relevant campus experts and resources to support their academic success, understanding of university level policies and practices and to assist them in advancing their personal and professional development.

Examples of resources offered through the Graduate Education Office include-but are not limited to:

- Website with university resources, contact information for CMU programs and services, calendar of events related to graduate students
- Bi-monthly email to all graduate students with information on activities, resources and opportunities
- Professional Development Seminars and Workshops
- GSA/Provost Conference Funding Grants
- GSA/Provost Small Research Grants (GuSH)
- Consultations on issues related to the graduate student experience

The Graduate Education Office also works with the colleges and departments by informing and assisting in developing policy and procedures relevant to graduate students and working with departments on issues related to graduate students. Additionally we partner with many other offices and organizations, such as the Graduate Student Assembly, to support the holistic graduate student educational experience.

Office of the Dean of Students

<https://www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/dean>

The Office of the Dean of Students provides central leadership of the metacurricular experience at Carnegie Mellon including the coordination of student support. Vice President of Student Affairs and Dean of Students Gina Casalegno leads the Division of Student Affairs which includes the offices and departments listed below (not an exhaustive list).

Graduate students will find the enrollment information for [Domestic Partner Registration and Maternity Accommodations](#) in the Office of the Dean of Students or on their [website](#). This Office also manages the [Emergency Student Loan \(ESLs\)](#) process. Emergency Student Loans are made available through generous gifts of alumni and friends of the university. The Emergency Student Loan is an interest-free, emergency-based loan repayable to the university within 30 days. Loans are available to enrolled students for academic supplies, medication, food or other expenses not able to be met due to unforeseeable circumstances.

Additional resources for graduate students include [College Liaisons](#) and the [Student Support Resources](#) team. [College Liaisons](#) are senior members of the Division of Student Affairs who work with departments and colleges addressing student concerns across a wide range of issues. College Liaisons are identified on the student SIO page in the Important Contacts list. The Student Support Resources team offers an additional level of support for students who are navigating any of a wide range of life events. [Student Support Resources](#) staff members work in partnership with campus and community resources to provide coordination of care and support appropriate to each student's situation.

The Division of Student Affairs includes (not an exhaustive list):

[Athletics, Physical Education and Recreation](#)
[Career and Professional Development Center \(CPDC\)](#)
[Center for Student Diversity and Inclusion](#)
[Cohon University Center](#)
[Counseling & Psychological Services \(CaPS\)](#)
[Dining Services](#)
[Office of Community Standards and Integrity \(OCSI\)](#)
[Office of Student Leadership, Involvement, and Civic Engagement \(SLICE\)](#)
[University Health Services \(UHS\)](#)

Wellness Initiatives

Center for Student Diversity & Inclusion

<https://www.cmu.edu/student-diversity/>

Diversity and inclusion have a singular place among the values of Carnegie Mellon University. The Center for Student Diversity & Inclusion actively cultivates a strong, diverse and inclusive community capable of living out these values and advancing research, creativity, learning and development that changes the world.

The Center offers resources to enhance an inclusive and transformative student experience in dimensions such as access, success, campus climate and intergroup dialogue. Additionally, the Center supports and connects historically underrepresented students and those who are first in their family to attend college in a setting where students' differences and talents are appreciated and reinforced, both at the graduate and undergraduate level. Initiatives coordinated by the Center include, but are not limited to:

- ☐ First generation/first in family to attend college programs
- ☐ LGBTQ+ Initiatives
- ☐ Race and ethnically-focused programs, including Inter-University Graduate Students of Color Series (SOC) and PhD SOC Network
- ☐ Women's empowerment programs, including Graduate Women's Gatherings (GWGs)
- ☐ Transgender and non-binary student programs

Assistance for Individuals with Disabilities

<http://www.cmu.edu/disability-resources/>

The Office of Disability Resources at Carnegie Mellon University has a continued mission to provide physical, digital, and programmatic access to ensure that students with disabilities have equal access to their educational experience. We work to ensure that qualified individuals receive reasonable accommodations as guaranteed by the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973. Students who would like to receive accommodations can begin the process through [Disability Resources' secure online portal](#) or email access@andrew.cmu.edu to begin the interactive accommodation process.

Students with physical, sensory, cognitive, or emotional disabilities are encouraged to self-identify with the Office of Disability Resources and request needed accommodations. Any questions about the process can be directed to access@andrew.cmu.edu, or call (412) 268-6121.

Eberly Center for Teaching Excellence & Educational Innovation

www.cmu.edu/teaching

We offer a wide variety of confidential, consultation services and professional development programs to support graduate students as teaching assistants or instructors of record during their time at Carnegie Mellon University and as future faculty members at other institutions. Regardless of one's current or future teaching context and duties, our goal is to disseminate evidence-based teaching strategies in ways that are accessible and actionable. Programs and services include campus-wide Graduate Student Instructor Orientation events and our Future Faculty Program, both of which are designed to help participants be effective and efficient in their teaching roles. The Eberly Center also assists departments in creating and conducting customized programs to meet the specific needs of their graduate student instructors. Specific information about Eberly Center support for graduate students is found at www.cmu.edu/teaching/graduatestudentsupport/index.html.

Graduate Student Assembly

www.cmu.edu/stugov/gsa/index.html

The Graduate Student Assembly (GSA) is the branch of Carnegie Mellon Student Government that represents, and advocates for the diverse interests of all graduate students at CMU. GSA is composed of representatives from the different graduate programs and departments who want to improve the graduate student experience at the different levels of the university. GSA is funded by the Student Activities Fee from all graduate students. GSA passes legislation, allocates student activities funding, advocates for legislative action locally and in Washington D.C. on behalf of graduate student issues and needs, and otherwise acts on behalf of all graduate student interests. Our recent accomplishments are a testament to GSA making a difference, and steps to implementing the vision laid out by the strategic plan. <https://www.cmu.edu/stugov/gsa/About-the-GSA/Strategic-Plan.html>.

GSA offers an expanding suite of social programming on and off-campus to bring graduate students from different departments together and build a sense of community. GSA is the host of the Graduate Student Lounge on the 3rd floor of the Cohon University Center- a great place to study or meet up with friends. GSA also maintains a website of graduate student resources on and off-campus. Through GSA's continued funding for professional development and research conferences, the GSA/Provost Conference Funding Program and GSA/Provost GuSH Research Grants are able to run, as managed by the Graduate Education Office. As we move forward, GSA will continue to rely on your feedback to improve the graduate student experience at CMU. Feel free to contact us at <gsa@cmu.edu> to get involved, stop by our office in the Cohon University Center Room 304 or become a representative for your department.

Office of International Education (OIE)

<http://www.cmu.edu/oie/>

Carnegie Mellon hosts international graduate and undergraduate students who come from more than 90 countries. The Office of International Education (OIE) is the liaison to the University for all non-immigrant students and scholars, as well the repository for study abroad opportunities and advisement. OIE provides many services including: advising on personal, immigration, study abroad, academic, and social and acculturation issues; presenting programs of interest such as international career workshops, tax workshops, and cross-cultural and immigration workshops; international education and statistics on international students in the United States; posting pertinent information to students through email and the OIE website, and conducting orientation and pre-departure programs.

Veterans and Military Community

<http://www.cmu.edu/veterans/>

Military veterans are a vital part of the Carnegie Mellon University community. Graduate students can find information on applying for veteran education benefits, campus services, veteran's groups at CMU, and non-educational resources through the Veterans and Military Community website. There are also links and connections to veteran resource in the Pittsburgh community. The ROTC and Veteran Affairs Coordinator can be reached at uro-vaedbenefits@andrew.cmu.edu or 412-268-8747.

Carnegie Mellon Ethics Hotline

<https://www.cmu.edu/hr/resources/ethics-hotline.html>

The health, safety and well-being of the university community are top priorities at Carnegie Mellon University. CMU provides a hotline that all members of the university community should use to confidentially report suspected unethical activity relating to areas below:

- Academic and Student Life

- Bias Reporting
- Environmental Health and Safety
- Financial Matters
- High-Risk Incident
- Human Resource Related
- Information Systems
- Research
- Threat of Business Interruption
- Threat of Violence or Physical Harm
- Title IX

Students, faculty and staff can anonymously file a report by calling 877-700-7050 or visiting www.reportit.net (user name: tartans; password: plaid). All submissions are reported to appropriate university personnel. The hotline is NOT an emergency service. For emergencies, call University Police at 412-268-2323.

Policy Against Retaliation

It is the policy of Carnegie Mellon University to protect from retaliation any individual who makes a good faith report of a suspected violation of any applicable law or regulation, university Policy or procedure, any contractual obligation of the university, and any report made pursuant to the Carnegie Mellon University Code of Business Ethics and Conduct.

Additional details regarding the Policy Against Retaliation are available at <https://www.cmu.edu/policies/administrative-and-governance/whistleblower.html>

Key Offices for Academic & Research Support

Computing and Information Resources

www.cmu.edu/computing

Computing Services maintains and supports computing resources for the campus community, including the campus wired and wireless networks, printing, computer labs, file storage, email and software catalog. As members of this community, we are all responsible for the security of these shared resources. Be sure to review the Safe Computing (<https://www.cmu.edu/computing/safe/>) section and the University Computing Policy (<https://www.cmu.edu/policies/information-technology/computing.html>)

Visit the Computing Services website (<https://www.cmu.edu/computing/>) to learn more. For assistance the Computing Services Help Center is available at 412-268-4357 (HELP) or it-help@cmu.edu.

Student Academic Success Center

<https://www.cmu.edu/student-success/>

Student Academic Support Programs

Tartan Scholars

The Tartan Scholars program was created to provide support for limited resourced students through an intentional first year undergraduate experience with the goals of enhancing the cohort's skill and community building through a lens of self-authorship, growth mindset, and a sense of belonging. As part of the Student Academic Success Center, Tartan Scholars are invited to join the

University and participate in summer initiatives and pre-orientation activities prior to their first year at the University.

There are opportunities for graduate students to serve as accountability, learning, or development partners, workshop facilitators, and presenters. Contact Diane Hightower at ddhighto@andrew.cmu.edu for more details.

Learning Support

Supplemental Instruction: Supplemental Instruction (SI) is an academic support model that utilizes peer-assisted study sessions. The SI program provides regularly scheduled review sessions on course materials outside the classroom. SI is a non-remedial approach to learning as the program targets high-risk courses and is available in select courses based on data related to past student performance and feasibility.

Peer Tutoring: Weekly Tutoring Appointments are offered in a one-on-one and small group format to students from any discipline who need assistance with a course that may not be supported by our other services. Weekly appointments give students the opportunity to interact regularly with the same tutor to facilitate deeper understanding of concepts. Students can register online through the Student Academic Success website.

Academic Coaching: Academic Coaching provides holistic one-on-one peer support and group workshops to help students find and implement their conditions for success. We assist students in improving time management, productive habits, organization, stress management, and study skills. Students will request support through the Academic Success Center website and attend in-person meetings or meet using video and audio conferencing technology to provide all students with support.

“Just in Time” Workshops: The Student Academic Success team is available to partner with instructors and departments to identify skills or concepts that would benefit from supplemental offerings (workshops, boot camps) to support students’ academic success and learning. We are eager to help convene and coordinate outside of the classroom skill-building opportunities that can be open to any student interested in building skill or reinforcing course concept mastery.

Study Partners: Support for students to create and benefit from their own study groups: The Student Academic Success team assists students in forming and benefiting from peer study groups, whereby all students can reap the benefits of peer-to-peer learning, student agency, and collaboration skill development. Staff from the Student Academic Success Center will be made available to instructors and students to assist with the formation of peer-led study groups. This level of support is open to any course where the instructor requests or agrees such support is appropriate and students are interested in both leading and participating.

Language and Cross-cultural Support

More than 60% of graduate students at Carnegie Mellon are international students, and others are nonnative speakers of English who have attended high school or undergraduate programs in the U.S. Many of these students want to hone their language and cross-cultural skills for academic and professional success. Students can choose from sessions on how to give a strong presentations, writing academic emails, expectations and strategies for clear academic writing, how to talk about yourself as a professional in the U.S., developing clearer pronunciation, using accurate grammar, building fluency, and more.

Students can make an appointment with a Language Development Specialist to get individualized coaching on language or cross-cultural issues.

The Student Academic Success Center is also charged with certifying the language of International Teaching Assistants (ITAs), ensuring that nonnative English speakers have the language proficiency needed to succeed as teaching assistants in the Carnegie Mellon classroom. Students preparing to do an ITA Certification should plan to take classes offered by the language support team at the SASC from the beginning of their first semester. Start by contacting the language support team at the SASC website or attend a Language Support Orientation at the SASC or in your department.

University Libraries

www.library.cmu.edu

The University Libraries offers a wide range of information resources and services supporting graduate students in course-work, research, teaching, and publishing. The library licenses and purchases books, journals, media and other needed materials in various formats. Library liaisons, consultants and information specialists provide in-depth and professional assistance and advice in all-things information - including locating and obtaining specific resources, providing specialized research support, advanced training in the use and management of data. Sign up for workshops and hands-on topic-specific sessions such as data visualization with Tableau, cleaning data with OpenRefine, and getting started with Zotero. Weekly drop-in hours for Digital Humanities and for Research Data Research Management are scheduled during the academic year. Start at the library home page to find the books, journals and databases you need; to identify and reach out to the library liaison in your field; to sign up for scheduled workshops; and to connect with consultants in scholarly publishing, research data management, and digital humanities.

Research at CMU

www.cmu.edu/research/index.shtml

The primary purpose of research at the university is the advancement of knowledge in all fields in which the university is active. Research is regarded as one of the university's major contributions to society and as an essential element in education, particularly at the graduate level and in faculty development. Research activities are governed by several university policies. Guidance and more general information is found by visiting the Research at Carnegie Mellon website.

Office of Research Integrity & Compliance

www.cmu.edu/research-compliance/index.html

The Office of Research Integrity & Compliance (ORIC) is designed to support research at Carnegie Mellon University. The staff work with researchers to ensure research is conducted with integrity and in accordance with federal and Pennsylvania regulation. ORIC assists researchers with human subject research, conflicts of interest, responsible conduct of research, export controls, and institutional animal care & use. ORIC also provides consultation, advice, and review of allegations of research misconduct.

Key Offices for Health, Wellness & Safety

Counseling & Psychological Services

<https://www.cmu.edu/counseling/>

Counseling & Psychological Services (CaPS) affords the opportunity for students to talk privately about academic and personal concerns in a safe, confidential setting. An initial consultation at CaPS can help clarify the nature of the concern, provide immediate support, and explore further options if needed. These may include a referral for counseling within CaPS, to another resource at Carnegie Mellon, or to another resource within the larger Pittsburgh community. CaPS also provides workshops and group sessions on mental health related topics

specifically for graduate students on campus. CaPS services are provided at no cost. Appointments can be made in person, or by telephone at 412-268-2922.

Health Services

www.cmu.edu/HealthServices/

University Health Services (UHS) is staffed by physicians, advanced practice clinicians and registered nurses who provide general medical care, allergy injections, first aid, gynecological care and contraception as well as on-site pharmaceuticals. The CMU Student Insurance Plan covers most visit fees to see the physicians and advanced practice clinicians & nurse visits. Fees for prescription medications, laboratory tests, diagnostic procedures and referral to the emergency room or specialists are the student's responsibility and students should review the UHS website and their insurance plan for detailed information about the university health insurance requirement and fees.

UHS also has a registered dietician and health promotion specialists on staff to assist students in addressing nutrition, drug and alcohol and other healthy lifestyle issues. In addition to providing direct health care, UHS administers the Student Health Insurance Program. The Student Health Insurance plan offers a high level of coverage in a wide network of health care providers and hospitals. Appointments can be made by visiting UHS's website, walk-in, or by telephone, 412-268-2157.

For non-Pittsburgh Students: University health services administers the Student Health Insurance Program. The Student Health Insurance plan offers a high level of coverage in a wide network of health care providers and hospitals. If students have any question about their health coverage they should contact Student Health Insurance at 412-268-2157.

Campus Wellness

<https://www.cmu.edu/wellness/>

At Carnegie Mellon, we believe our individual and collective well-being is rooted in healthy connections to each other and to campus resources. The university provides a wide variety of wellness, mindfulness and connectedness initiatives and resources designed to help students thrive inside and outside the classroom. The BeWell@CMU e-newsletter seeks to be a comprehensive resource for CMU regarding all wellness-inspired events, announcements and professional and personal development opportunities. Sign up for the Be Well monthly newsletter via <https://bit.ly/BeWellNewsletter> or by contacting the Program Director for Student Affairs Wellness Initiatives, at alusk@andrew.cmu.edu.

Religious and Spiritual Life Initiatives (RSLI)

www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/spirituality

Carnegie Mellon is committed to the holistic growth of our students, including creating opportunities for spiritual and religious practice and exploration. We have relationships with local houses of worship from various traditions and many of these groups are members of CMU's Council of Religious Advisors. We also offer programs and initiatives that cross traditional religious boundaries in order to increase knowledge of and appreciation for the full diversity of the worldview traditions. Our RSLI staff are here to support students across the spectrum of religious and spiritual practice and would be more than happy to help you make a connection into a community of faith during your time at CMU.

University Police

<http://www.cmu.edu/police/>

412-268-2323 (emergency only), 412-268-6232 (non-emergency)

For Pittsburgh Students: The University Police Department is located at 300 South Craig Street (entrance is on Filmore Street). The department's services include police patrols and call response, criminal investigations, fixed officer and foot officer patrols, event security, and crime prevention and education programming as well as bicycle and laptop registration. Visit the department's website for additional information about the staff, emergency phone locations, crime prevention, lost and found, finger print services, and annual statistic reports.

For non-Pittsburgh students: In the case of an emergency, call 911.

For all MSCF Students: Carnegie Mellon University publishes an annual campus security and fire safety report describing the university's security, alcohol and drug, sexual assault, and fire safety policies and containing statistics about the number and type of crimes committed on the campus and the number and cause of fires in campus residence facilities during the preceding three years. Graduate students can obtain a copy by contacting the University Police Department at 412-268-6232. The annual security and fire safety report is also available online at <https://www.cmu.edu/police/annualreports/>.

Shuttle and Escort Services

For Pittsburgh MSCF Students: Parking and Transportation coordinates the Shuttle Service and Escort Service provided for CMU students, faculty, and community. The [Shuttle & Escort website](#) has full information about these services, stops, routes, tracking and schedules.

The WORD

<http://www.cmu.edu/student-affairs/theword//>

The WORD is Carnegie Mellon University's student on-line handbook and is considered a supplement to the department (and sometimes college) handbook. The WORD contains campus resources and opportunities, academic policy information and resources, community standards information and resources. It is designed to provide all students with the tools, guidance, and insights to help you achieve your full potential as a member of the Carnegie Mellon community.

Information about the following is included in The WORD (not an exhaustive list) and graduate students are encouraged to bookmark this site and refer to it often. University policies can also be found in full text at: <http://www.cmu.edu/policies/>.

Carnegie Mellon Vision, Mission
Statement of Assurance
Carnegie Code

Academic Standards, Policies and Procedures
Educational Goals
Academic and Individual Freedom
Statement on Academic Integrity Standards for Academic & Creative Life
Assistance for Individuals with Disabilities
Master's Student Statute of Limitations
Conduct of Classes
Copyright Policy
Cross-college & University Registration
Doctoral Student Status Policy
Evaluation & Certification of English Fluency for Instructors
Final Exams for Graduate Courses
Grading Policies
Intellectual Property Policy
Privacy Rights of Students

Student's Rights

Research

Human Subjects in Research

Office of Research Integrity & Compliance

Office of Sponsored Programs

Policy for Handling Alleged Misconduct of Research

Policy on Restricted Research

Tax Status of Graduate Student Awards

Campus Resources & Opportunities

Alumni Relations

Assistance for Individuals with Disabilities

Athletics, Physical Fitness & Recreation

Carnegie Mellon ID Cards and Services

Cohon University Center

Copying, Printing & Mailing

Division of Student Affairs

Domestic Partner Registration

Emergency Student Loan Program

Gender Programs & Resources

Health Services

Dining Services

The HUB Student Services Center

ID Card Services

Leonard Gelfand Center

LGBTQ Resources

Multicultural and Diversity Initiatives

Opportunities for Involvement

Parking and Transportation Services

Shuttle and Escort Services

Spiritual Development

University Police

Student Activities

University Stores

Community Standards, Policies and Procedures

Alcohol and Drugs Policy

AIDS Policy

Bicycle/Wheeled Transportation Policy

Damage to Carnegie Mellon Property

Deadly Weapons

Discriminatory Harassment

Disorderly Conduct

Equal Opportunity/Affirmative Action Policy

Freedom of Expression Policy

Health Insurance Policy Immunization Policy

Missing Student Protocol

Non-Discrimination Policy

On-Campus Emergencies

Pets

Political Activities

Recycling Policy

Riotous and Disorderly Behavior

Safety Hazards

Scheduling and Use of University Facilities

Sexual Harassment and Sexual Assault Policy

Smoking Policy

Student Accounts Receivable and Collection Policy and Procedures

Student Activities Fee

Student Enterprises

Workplace Threats and Violence Policy